University life and study skills (Listening Sections 3 and 4)

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Learning how to study at university (183 words)

Starting a degree is as much a change in habits as in subject. In the first weeks, students discover that a good **timetable** matters more than raw talent. Each **module** brings regular **assignment** tasks, and a missed **deadline** can cost marks unless the tutor grants an **extension**. Teaching takes several forms: a **lecture** introduces ideas to a large audience, while a **seminar** or a smaller **tutorial** asks students to **take part in** discussion and defend their views.

Independent research is the heart of the course. A final-year **dissertation** is guided by a **supervisor**, who helps the student define a clear **hypothesis** and choose a suitable **methodology**. Some projects rely on a **questionnaire** or a larger **survey**, and the quality of any result depends on the **sample**: a group that is too small cannot support firm conclusions. Writing the **abstract** and the **lab report** teaches students to present their **findings** clearly.

Above all, academic honesty is essential. Every **reference** must be listed in the **bibliography**, because **plagiarism** can end a degree. Students who **keep on top of** their workload and **seek help early** usually do best.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
take part in	join
keep on top of	manage well
seek help early	ask for help before problems grow

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
assignment	n	a piece of work given to a student	*The assignment is due on Friday.*
deadline	n	the last time to finish something	*She asked for an extension to the deadline.*
tutorial	n	a small class with a tutor	*The tutorial helps us discuss the reading.*
seminar	n	a class where students discuss a topic	*Each student presents in the seminar.*
dissertation	n	a long piece of writing for a degree	*He is writing a dissertation on climate.*
bibliography	n	a list of books used in a piece of work	*Include a bibliography at the end.*

plagiarism	n	using someone's work as your own	*Plagiarism can lead to failing the course.*
reference	n	a source mentioned in an essay	*You must give a reference for every quote.*
supervisor	n	a teacher who guides a research project	*My supervisor suggested a new method.*
questionnaire	n	a list of questions for collecting information	*We sent a questionnaire to 200 students.*
survey	n	a study of what people think or do	*The survey showed a clear preference.*
sample	n	a small group chosen for a study	*The sample was too small.*
hypothesis	n	an idea to be tested	*The experiment tested the hypothesis.*
methodology	n	the methods used in a study	*The methodology is explained in section two.*
findings	n	the results of research	*The findings were surprising.*
abstract	n	a short summary of a paper	*Read the abstract first.*
lab report	n	a written report on an experiment	*Her lab report received good marks.*
extension	n	extra time to finish work	*The tutor gave him a week's extension.*
module	n	one part of a university course	*She chose a module in psychology.*
timetable	n	a list of when classes happen	*The timetable changes every semester.*

Practice: fill the gaps

seminar · assignment · plagiarism · abstract · extension · supervisor · timetable · module

1. Each student presents in the _____.
2. The _____ is due on Friday.
3. _____ can lead to failing the course.
4. Read the _____ first.
5. The tutor gave him a week's _____.
6. My _____ suggested a new method.
7. The _____ changes every semester.
8. She chose a _____ in psychology.

More words on this topic **(not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)**

academic year (n): the school or university year
attendance (n): being present at classes
campus (n): the grounds of a university
cite (v): to mention a source
citation (n): a note naming a source
credit (n): a unit of course work
degree (n): a qualification from a university
dean (n): a senior university official
discipline (n): a field of study
draft (n): an early version of a text
essay (n): a short piece of writing
exam (n): a test of knowledge
feedback (n): comments to improve work
grade (n): a mark for work
handout (n): a printed sheet given in class
journal (n): a publication of research

library (n): a place with books
literature review (n): a summary of earlier research
major (n): the main subject of a degree
marking (n): checking and grading work
oral presentation (n): a spoken talk to a group
paraphrase (v): to say in different words
peer review (n): checking by other experts
proofread (v): to check for mistakes
reading list (n): books you should read
resit (v): to take an exam again
revision (n): studying before an exam
semester (n): half of the academic year
transcript (n): a record of a student's marks

Answers

1. seminar (seminar)
2. assignment (assignment)
3. Plagiarism (plagiarism)
4. abstract (abstract)
5. extension (extension)
6. supervisor (supervisor)
7. timetable (timetable)
8. module (module)